

The Fruit of the Spirit: Character That Grows

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Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-17

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

Book 74 of 80

Scene 1 of 25

[PICTURE: The apostle Paul sitting in a room writing a letter, with a map of Galatia visible on the wall behind him. Through the window, a distant view of churches scattered across the Anatolian landscape. His face shows deep concern mixed with love. On the table beside him, broken chains represent the freedom he writes about. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Paul's letter to the Galatians was written in urgency and passion. The churches in Galatia — modern-day Turkey — were being deceived. False teachers had arrived after Paul left, telling these new believers that faith in Christ was not enough. They insisted that to truly belong to God, people had to follow the entire Jewish law: circumcision, dietary rules, sabbath observances, and hundreds of other regulations. Paul was devastated. These believers had experienced freedom in Christ — the glorious truth that God accepts us through faith, not through our performance — and now they were voluntarily putting themselves back under slavery to rules. Paul writes with the intensity of a father watching his children walk back into a prison they had just been freed from. "It is for freedom that Christ has set you free," he declares. "Stand firm, then, and do not let yourselves be burdened again by a yoke of slavery." But Paul knows that freedom without direction leads to chaos. So he introduces something revolutionary: the fruit of the Spirit — character that grows not from human effort but from divine cultivation.

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*BiMenfes temelalesu dilet siga dima ayKitifit'smun iKhum. Izi nay Pawlos ma'ikelay
 ti'izaz iyu — diHriu zimits'e kulu ziKefit qulfi. "Ts'ibuq kitiKhewn ziyada ts'e'ar" kem
 zeykone astebhil. "Zibezhe Higtat si'ab" aykonen. "BiHayli dilet diletKa ts'eqiT"
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Scene 3 of 25

[PICTURE: A dark, thorny garden representing the "works of the flesh." Each thorn bush produces a different dark fruit labeled with words like sexual immorality, hatred, jealousy, rage, selfish ambition, and drunkenness. The garden is chaotic, with plants strangling each other, fighting for space. No gardener is present — it grows wild and destructive on its own. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Before describing the Spirit's fruit, Paul lists what life WITHOUT the Spirit produces — the "works of the flesh." Notice the word: WORKS. The flesh produces through effort, striving, and self-will. "The acts of the flesh are obvious: sexual immorality, impurity and debauchery; idolatry and witchcraft; hatred, discord, jealousy, fits of rage, selfish ambition, dissensions, factions and envy; drunkenness, orgies, and the like." This is not a random list — it is a portrait of human nature left to itself. Without the Spirit, this is what we naturally produce. Sexual sins come from seeking intimacy and pleasure apart from God's design. Idolatry comes from worshipping anything other than God. Hatred, jealousy, rage, and selfish ambition come from the desperate need to protect and promote the self. Drunkenness comes from trying to escape pain without the Spirit's comfort. Paul is not trying to shame anyone — he is showing what happens when humans try to live without God's power. The flesh doesn't need to be taught to sin. Left alone, it produces destruction as naturally as weeds grow without planting.

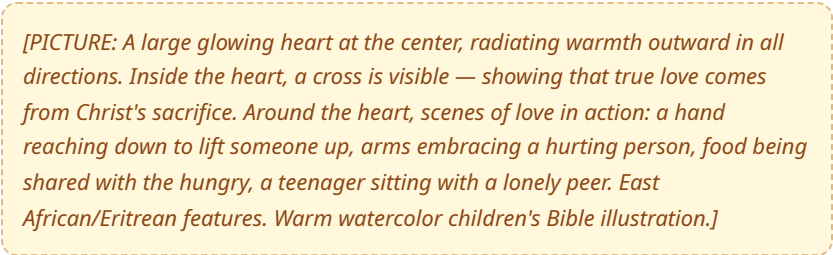
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Qidmi fire Menfes migilats' Pawlos bizey Menfes hiyotet intay kem tefri yizirzir — "gibirtat siga." Qal astebhil: gibirtat. Siga bits'e'iri, bimiqilqal, bigeza'e ri'isi fiqad yiferi. "Gibirtat siga giluts'at iyen: zimut, riKhiset, ibdan, amilKho Ta'ot, Tinqola, ts'il'i, ba'isi, qin'i, quT'a, shewihat geza'e ri'isi, mifillay, selfiitat, qin'i, siKhiran, zeyqinu'e desta, kemzi zi'ameselu'n."

Fire Menfes gina... Wesani neger astebhil: Pawlos fire yibil, firetat zeykone. Nits'il, bizuH zeykone. Gibirtat siga bizuH iyom — zitebetenu, zeyti'asiseru nay amets' tegbarat. Ginake Menfes Hade Habiru zelo fire bitish'ate agelaltsa yiferi. Izi aziyu agedasi iyu. Nay Menfes bahriy ayenay kifal kem tideli kitimerits' aytiKh'ilin.

Scene 5 of 25



LOVE — agape, choosing another's good regardless of feeling. The first fruit Paul lists is love — and it is first for a reason. Love is not merely the first item in a list; it is the root from which all other fruits grow. Without love, joy becomes selfish pleasure, peace becomes indifference, patience becomes passive aggression, and kindness becomes manipulation. Agape love — the Greek word Paul uses — is entirely different from romantic love (eros) or friendship love (phileo). Agape is a deliberate choice to seek another person's highest good regardless of how you feel about them, regardless of whether they deserve it, regardless of whether they reciprocate. It is the love God showed us: "While we were still sinners, Christ died for us." We did nothing to earn it. We did nothing to deserve it. He chose our good over His comfort — that is agape. The Spirit grows this same love in us, enabling us to love people who are difficult, to love enemies, to love without condition. This love is supernatural — it goes beyond what human willpower can achieve.

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*Fiqri — Agape, bizeyegedis simi'it ts'ibuq kal'e mimirats'. Pawlos qedamay zizirziro
 fire fiqri iya — qedamay mikniyat alewo. Fiqri ab zirizir qedamay tiray aykonettin —
 kulom kal'ot firetat zibequlula sur iya. Bizey fiqri Hagos hirifan desta yiKhewn, selam
 zeygdasnet yiKhewn, aqalnet siqitawi ts'il'i yiKhewn, lewahnet mitilal yiKhewn.*

Scene 6 of 25

[PICTURE: A series of vignettes showing teenagers practicing love in daily life: one defending a bullied classmate, another putting down their phone to listen to a parent, one sharing their lunch with someone who has none, another writing an encouraging note to a struggling friend. Each act of love is surrounded by a soft glow showing the Spirit at work. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Love in practice for teens — what it looks like daily. Agape love is not abstract theology; it is intensely practical. For a teenager, love looks like: choosing not to gossip about someone even when everyone else is doing it. It looks like defending someone being bullied even when it costs you social status. It looks like forgiving a friend who hurt you rather than giving them the silent treatment. It looks like putting down your phone to genuinely listen to your parent. It looks like including the lonely kid at your lunch table. It looks like praying for someone you dislike rather than plotting against them. Love is not a feeling you wait to arrive — it is a choice you make every single day. The Spirit empowers this choice. When your flesh says "they don't deserve kindness," the Spirit whispers "neither did you, and I loved you anyway." When your flesh says "protect yourself, don't be vulnerable," the Spirit says "I protect you — you are free to love without fear." Each daily choice to love, empowered by the Spirit, is the fruit growing on your branch. It starts small — a kind word here, forgiveness there — but over years, it produces a character of love that transforms every relationship you have.

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Fiqri nimeniseyyat ab gibri — ilet ilet kemey kem timesil. Agape fiqri abstrakt sine melekot aykonen — aziyu gibirawi iyu. Nimenisiy fiqri kemzi timesil: kulu seb kigebir kelo'kwa biza'iba Hade seb zeymiHimay mimirats'. Mahberawi dereja waga kiKefileKa kelo'kwa zibilts' zelo seb mikilikhal timesil.

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*Hagos — bizeyegedis kunetat amiq Hagos. Kal'ay fire Hagos iyu — ginake alem
 zihibo Hagos aykonen. Hagos ab fits'ametata yimirkos. Ts'ibuq negarrat mis zikhewn
 Higus tism'aKa. Himaq negarrat mis zikhewn Hagos yibenin. Ginake Hagos zitefelye
 iyu. Hagos kunetat kitinki'e zeyKh'il neger ziseretu amiq zitetaTaHe Hagos iyu.*

Scene 8 of 25

[PICTURE: Two glasses side by side. One is labeled "Happiness" and is being filled from external sources — likes on a phone, good grades, friends laughing — but it has cracks and leaks constantly. The other is labeled "Joy" and is filled from an internal spring at the bottom, overflowing steadily regardless of what's happening outside. A teenager looks at both, beginning to understand the difference. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Joy vs. happiness — why teens need this distinction. Your generation faces unprecedented pressure to appear happy. Social media creates a constant performance of happiness — curated photos, perfect moments, highlight reels that suggest everyone else is living their best life. But happiness based on external circumstances is exhausting and fragile. You will lose friendships, fail exams, face rejection, experience heartbreak, encounter injustice. If your joy depends on life going well, you will spend most of your life joyless. This is why the Spirit's joy is revolutionary. It does not depend on your grades, your social status, your appearance, your relationship status, or your followers count. It is rooted in truths that never change: God loves you with an everlasting love. Christ has secured your eternity. The Holy Spirit dwells within you RIGHT NOW. Nothing can separate you from God's love. These truths create a bedrock joy that sustains you when everything external crumbles. You can grieve and still have joy. You can struggle and still have joy. You can face the worst day of your life and still, underneath it all, know that you are held, loved, and destined for glory. This is the gift the Spirit grows in you.

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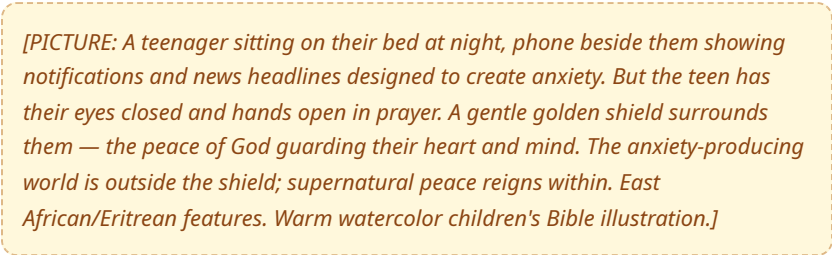
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*Hagos ants'ar Hagos — nimintay meniseyyat nezi fililay kem zedliyom. Weledokhum
Higus koynKa nimri'ay qidmi Hiji zeynebere ts'eqTi yigaTmo. Social media qets'ali nay
Hagos tiri'it yifeTir — zitemerits'e si'ilitat, fits'um himotat, kulu seb zibeleTse hiyowetu
yinebir kem zelo zi'imit nay bluts'at himotat si'ilitat.*

[illegible]

*Selam — Shalom, miu'enet, mis Amlakn kal'otn irqi. DiHri nayzi qal zelo nay
ibraystiTi Hasab Shalom iyu — kab zeymihlaw girichit aziyu zibezH malet iyu. Shalom
milu'e milu'enet, Teqilala Ti'ina, kulu Amlak kem ziqeretso ziserH malet iyu. Nay
Menfes selam ab seleste dereja yiserH.*

Scene 10 of 25



Peace in an anxious generation — practical application. Your generation has been called the most anxious in recorded history. You face constant information overload, social comparison, academic pressure, uncertain futures, global crises displayed 24/7 on your screens, and a culture that offers no solid ground to stand on. Anxiety is not a spiritual failure — it is an honest response to a broken world. But the Spirit offers something the world cannot: "The peace of God, which transcends all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus." This peace does not mean you will never feel anxious. It means that in the midst of anxiety, there is an anchor. Practically, accessing this peace looks like: pausing when anxiety rises and acknowledging God's presence. Naming your fears honestly before Him rather than hiding them. Choosing to believe what God says about your future over what your anxious thoughts predict. Turning off the noise — the news, the social media, the comparison — and sitting in silence with God. Peace is cultivated, not manufactured. It grows as you practice bringing your anxiety to God rather than carrying it alone. "Cast all your anxiety on him because he cares for you."

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Mis hidet aqalnet — nilmintay qits'betawi wits'itat nay Amlak mengedi zeykone. Ab nay qits'bet kulu alem tinebir: qits'betawi meli'Khititat, qits'betawi mezenagi'i, qits'betawi megbi, qits'betawi melistat. Izi i'imroKha ab kulu awdi qits'betawi wits'itat kits'be yiselTino — menfesawi ibyet Hawiska.

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*Lewahnet — niKhal'ot niTuf ts'ibuq, nay Menfes legasnet. Ab mets'Haf Qidus lewahnet
"ts'ibuq" miwKhan tiray aykonen. Ts'ibuq miwKhan qesinKa mits'naH iyu — gudaat
yiwgid. Lewahnet niTuf iyu — ts'ibuq yisi'ab. Nay griKh qal "Khrestotes" nay Teqimi
Hasab yiHiz, niKhal'ot Teqami miwKhan, legasin wehabin tefeTriro mihlaw.*

Scene 14 of 25

[PICTURE: A teenager standing against a strong current (representing a harsh, unkind culture) while extending a hand to help someone else. Around them, people are being swept away by cruelty, sarcasm, and indifference — represented as dark water. The teen's kindness is like a rock in the river, creating a shelter where others can rest. Their countercultural compassion stands out like light in darkness. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Kindness in a harsh world — countercultural compassion. Your world rewards harshness. Social media celebrates the cleverest insults, the most savage takedowns, the sharpest sarcasm. Reality shows reward backstabbing. Comedy often depends on cruelty. Political discourse thrives on dehumanizing the other side. In this environment, kindness is revolutionary. Being genuinely kind — not as weakness but as strength — is one of the most countercultural things a teenager can do today. Kindness means: responding to insults with grace instead of retaliation. Speaking well of people behind their backs. Giving others the benefit of the doubt. Treating servers, janitors, and "invisible" people with dignity. Celebrating others' successes without jealousy. Offering help without being asked. Making people feel valued in a world that constantly ranks them. The Spirit enables this countercultural kindness because He fills you with something the culture cannot: genuine concern for others that flows from being genuinely loved yourself. When you know you are deeply loved by God, you have no need to tear others down to feel good about yourself. You are free to be kind — lavishly, extravagantly, unreasonably kind — because your worth is already secured.

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Lewahnet ab cheykan alem — bahli zits'arer riHraHe. AlemKa nicheykannet tishilim. Social media nizibezHe bilHat zelewō ts'erifi, niziHayele miber'an, nizibezHe siHit zelewō miHiyal yiKhbir. Nay Haqi tiri'it nay diHrit miwga'e yishilim. Komedi bizuH gize ab chiKane yimirkos.

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Ts'ibuaq miwKhan — moralawi biluts'net, ab bahriy nits'uhnet. Ts'ibuaq miwKhan kab lewahnet nila'ili yiKeyd. Lewahnet lisilsitin ts'egawitin iya — ts'ibuaq miwKhan adlayi koynu mis ziKhewn difurin zits'arerin kiKhewn yiKh'il. Nay griKh qal "agathosune" moralawi biluts'net malet iyu.

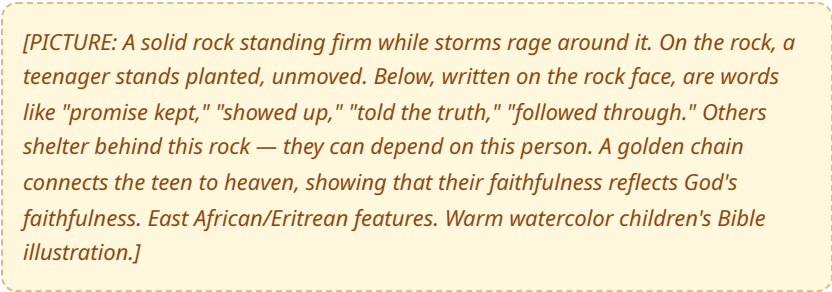
Scene 16 of 25

[PICTURE: A split image showing a teenager's public life (on stage, with friends, performing) on the left, and their private life (alone in their room, in secret choices, in their thought life) on the right. Both halves match perfectly — the same character, the same integrity. Between the two halves, a golden thread connects them, showing consistency. The word "Integrity" bridges both worlds. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Goodness when no one is watching — private character. The true test of goodness is not what you do when everyone is watching but what you do when no one is. Your public character is your reputation; your private character is your reality. Many people perform goodness publicly while living very differently in private. But the Spirit's work goes to the deepest level — transforming not just your behavior but your desires, not just your actions but your thought life. Goodness that grows from the Spirit is the same in the dark as in the light. It means: what you browse when you're alone online reflects the same values you profess publicly. How you treat family members at home — where there's no audience to impress — reveals your true character. What you think about people (not just what you say to them) shows whether goodness has reached your heart. The choices you make when you know you won't get caught are the truest measure of who you are. Ask yourself: if everything I did in private this week was projected on a screen for everyone to see, would it match the person I present to the world? The Spirit's goal is to make those two versions of you into one — to produce genuine, consistent goodness that needs no audience to motivate it.

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Scene 17 of 25



FAITHFULNESS — reliability, trustworthiness, covenant-keeping. In a world of broken promises and casual commitments, faithfulness is extraordinary. The Greek word "pistis" means faith and faithfulness simultaneously — trusting God and being trustworthy go hand in hand. A faithful person is someone others can count on. They show up when they say they will. They keep secrets entrusted to them. They follow through on commitments even when it's inconvenient. They tell the truth even when lies would be easier. They remain loyal to friends even when those friends are going through difficult seasons. Faithfulness reflects God's character more than almost any other quality. God is described as "faithful" more than almost any other attribute. He keeps every promise. He never abandons His people. He shows up every single day without fail. When the Spirit grows faithfulness in you, you become a reflection of God's nature in a world desperate for people who keep their word. Faithfulness is rare today — which makes it even more powerful. When you are faithful, people notice. They trust you. They lean on you. They see God's character in your consistency.

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Amunnet — te'amannet, immunet, qal kidan mi'qab. Ab nay zitesebru tesfatatn limud qal kidanatn alem amunnet fluy iyu. Nay griKh qal "pistis" imnetin amunnetin biHansab malet iyu — Amlak mi'imanin amun miwKhanin id ni'id yiKheda.

Amunnet — te'amannet, immunet, qal kidan mi'qab. Ab nay zitesebru tesfatatn limud qal kidanatn alem amunnet fluy iyu. Nay griKh qal "pistis" imnetin amunnetin biHansab malet iyu — Amlak mi'imanin amun miwKhanin id ni'id yiKheda.

Scene 18 of 25

[PICTURE: A series of small, everyday scenes showing faithfulness: a teenager arriving on time to meet a friend, completing homework honestly, keeping a promise to a younger sibling, showing up to volunteer when no one else did, texting back when they said they would. Each small act is like a brick being placed — together they build a massive, strong tower of trustworthiness. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Faithfulness in small things — proving trustworthy. Jesus said, "Whoever can be trusted with very little can also be trusted with much." Faithfulness is not about grand gestures — it is built in the small, unglamorous, daily decisions. Show up on time. Return what you borrow. Do what you say you will do. Finish what you start. Keep the secrets people share with you. Be consistent in your prayers. Follow through on your commitments even when no one is checking. These small acts of faithfulness build a track record that God sees and others eventually recognize. God tests faithfulness in small things before entrusting larger responsibilities. David was faithful with sheep before he was trusted with a kingdom. Joseph was faithful in Potiphar's house before he was given authority over Egypt. The disciples were faithful in following Jesus daily before they were entrusted with the entire church. If you want God to use you in big ways, be faithful NOW in the small things right in front of you. Your bedroom, your homework, your friendships, your family responsibilities, your quiet time with God — these are your training ground. Every small faithfulness is building the character God will one day use to change the world through you.

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*Lisilusnet — tiHitna, ab quTs'Ts'ir zelo Hayli. Lisilusnet kab aziyom ziteredu'u begagi
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 biqelilu tidifen miwKhan. Ginake mets'Haf Qidusawi Hasab lisilusnet (griKh
 "pra'utes") nay diKham lik'e tets'arari iyu. Ab quTs'Ts'ir zelo Hayli iyu.*

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*Ab Hayli lisilusnet — diKham zeykone migita'e. Nimeniseyyat lisilusnet aziyu nibahli
 zits'arer fire kitiKhewn tiKh'il. AlemKa nits'ebats'net, ablalinett, ziHayele dimts'i,
 ziHayele akwab, ziHayele mimilis yiKhbir. Lisilusnet abta alem kem diKham timesil.*

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*Ri'ise git'at — li'ili diKhitat mibilats', biMenfes Hayli zitewahbe sir'at. Nay meweda'eta
fire ri'ise git'at iyu — nay meweda'eta sle zikone aykonen ziwiHade agedasnetu
ginake niKhal'ot kulom ziHiz bota sle zikone iyu.*

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Ri'ise git'at ab zemen qits'betawi igbet. Ab ri'ise git'at nimi'inaw zitehandese alem tinebir. Ab telefonika zelo kulu app bibluts'at sine-i'imronyatat welifi kiKhewn zitiqeretse iyu — kitiskrol, kiTiwiq, kitibeli'e nimi'qab.

[illegible]

Nikemzi zi'amesele ziKelKil Higi yelen. Pawlos geletsa fire bizi amiq Hasab yizazim. Hisebo: ab zikone bota Higi yelen — ab zikone maHber Higi yelen, ab zikone bahlil moralawi Higi yelen, ab zikone awid denbi yelen — fiqri, Hagos, selam, aqalnet, lewahnet, ts'ibuq miwKhan, amunnet, lisilusnet wey ri'ise git'at ziKelKil.

Scene 24 of 25

[PICTURE: A grapevine with a branch clearly attached to it, bearing abundant fruit. The branch is doing nothing except remaining connected — no straining, no effort visible. The life flows naturally from the vine through the branch and produces fruit automatically. Beside it, a detached branch lies on the ground, withered and fruitless despite looking like it's trying hard. Jesus stands as the vine, and a teenager is the connected branch. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

How fruit grows — abiding in Christ, not striving harder. Jesus said in John 15: "I am the vine; you are the branches. If you remain in me and I in you, you will bear much fruit; apart from me you can do nothing." This is the secret to fruit-bearing: it's not about trying harder but about staying connected. A branch does not strain to produce grapes. It doesn't grunt and sweat and push to create fruit. It simply remains attached to the vine, and the life of the vine flows through it naturally, producing fruit without effort. Your job is not to manufacture the fruit of the Spirit through willpower. Your job is to ABIDE — to stay connected to Christ through prayer, Scripture, worship, fellowship, and obedience. When you are deeply connected to Him, His life flows through you, and fruit appears naturally. This is why some of the most fruitful Christians you know don't seem to be trying very hard — they're simply close to Jesus, and His character overflows from that closeness. Conversely, fruitlessness is always a connection problem, not an effort problem. If you're not seeing fruit, don't try harder — get closer. Spend more time with Jesus. Let His Word soak into your heart. Stay in community. The fruit will come.

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Fire biKemey yi'abi — ub Kristos mits'naH ziyada mits'e'ar zeykone. Yesus ab Yohanis 15 "ane weyni nisKhatKum cheynafir iKhum. Abay mis tits'enHu ane dima abaKhum bizuH fire kitiferyu iKhum — bizey ane zikone kitgebru aytiKh'ilun" bele. Izi nay fire mifray misitir iyu: biziYada mits'e'ar biza'iba aykonen te'asisirKa mits'naH iyu.

Scene 25 of 25

[PICTURE: A teenager in a garden, cooperating with a divine Gardener (represented by golden hands from above). The teen holds a watering can and tends the soil (representing daily spiritual disciplines), while the Gardener's hands bring sunshine and rain (representing divine grace and power). Together — human cooperation and divine cultivation — produce a beautiful garden overflowing with the nine fruits. The teen looks up with trust and surrender. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Application: cooperating with the Spirit's growth process daily. The fruit of the Spirit is not produced by human effort alone, but neither does it grow without human cooperation. You are a garden, and God is the Gardener — but you have a role too. Your role is to cooperate with His cultivation. Practically, this means: spending daily time with God in prayer and Scripture — this is sunlight and water for your soul. Staying in community with other believers — this is the fertile soil of encouragement and accountability. Saying yes to the Spirit's promptings throughout your day — when He nudges you to be patient, kind, or self-controlled, respond. Confessing quickly when you fail rather than hiding — this is weeding the garden. Being willing to endure the pruning — the uncomfortable growth that comes through trials, correction, and waiting. Remember: the nine fruits are not a checklist to achieve but a portrait of Christ forming in you. As you grow closer to Jesus, you will naturally become more loving, more joyful, more peaceful, more patient, more kind, more good, more faithful, more gentle, and more self-controlled — because you are becoming more like HIM. Surrender the growth process to God daily. Trust His timing. Cooperate with His Spirit. And watch, over months and years, as character grows that no human effort could have produced — the beautiful, supernatural fruit of the Spirit.

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Tegbar: mis nay Menfes ibyet hidet ilet ilet mitihbibar. Fire Menfes binay seb ts'e'iri nibeynu ayferin ginake bizey nay seb mitihbibar'win ay'abin. NisKha genet iKha Amlak dima Hareshay — ginake tera'win aleKa. TeraKha mis minbayu mitihbibar iyu.

ገላ 5:22-23 - "እነዚህ ስሜቶች ስለሚገኙት ሰው ምን ዓይነት ሰው እንደሆነ ያሳያሉ፡፡
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እነዚህ ስሜቶች ስለሚገኙት ሰው ምን ዓይነት ሰው እንደሆነ ያሳያሉ፡፡"

Discussion Questions

1. Paul contrasts the "works of the flesh" with the "fruit of the Spirit." Works implies human effort and striving; fruit implies organic growth. Why is this distinction so important? How does understanding that character is grown (not manufactured) change the way you approach spiritual growth? What happens when you try to produce fruit through willpower alone?

1. ስለ "ሰጠው ስራ" ለ "ሰጠው ፍጥነት" ስለሚለው ልዩነት ስለ ስራ ስለሚለው ልዩነት — ስለ ስራው ስለሚለው ልዩነት ስለ ስራው ስለሚለው ልዩነት? ስለሰጠው ፍጥነት (ሰጠው) ስለ ስራው ስለሚለው ልዩነት ስለ ስራው ስለሚለው ልዩነት? ስለሰጠው ፍጥነት ስለ ስራው ስለሚለው ልዩነት?

2. Of the nine fruits of the Spirit — love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control — which one do you most need the Spirit to develop in you right now? Be specific about why, and what situations in your life reveal that need. What would it look like for that fruit to grow in you this month?

2. ስለ ስራው ስለሚለው ልዩነት — ስለሰጠው ፍጥነት ስለ ስራው ስለሚለው ልዩነት ስለ ስራው ስለሚለው ልዩነት? ስለሰጠው ፍጥነት ስለ ስራው ስለሚለው ልዩነት ስለ ስራው ስለሚለው ልዩነት? ስለሰጠው ፍጥነት ስለ ስራው ስለሚለው ልዩነት?

3. Jesus said "abide in me" as the key to bearing fruit. What does it practically mean to "abide" in Christ in your daily teenage life? What specific practices keep you connected to the vine? What disconnects you? How can you tell when you're abiding versus just going through religious motions?

4. What is the difference between self-improvement (trying harder to be good through willpower) and Spirit-transformation (the Spirit changing you from within)? Have you experienced the failure of willpower-based change? What does it look like to surrender an area of your character to the Spirit rather than trying to fix it yourself?

5. How do you cultivate character versus manufacturing it? A gardener cannot force a plant to grow, but they can create the right conditions. What are the "right conditions" that allow the Spirit's fruit to grow in your life? What weeds need to be pulled? What soil needs to be prepared? What practices create space for the Spirit's work?

[illegible]

A Prayer for the Fruit of the Spirit

Holy Spirit, we come to You as the divine Gardener of our souls. We confess that we have tried too often to produce fruit through our own effort — striving, performing, trying harder — and we are exhausted. We surrender the growth process to You today.

Grow LOVE in us — the kind that chooses others' good even when we don't feel like it. Grow JOY in us — the deep gladness that no circumstance can steal. Grow PEACE in us — the shalom that anchors us in the storm. Grow PATIENCE in us — the long-suffering that trusts Your timing even when the wait feels endless.

Grow KINDNESS in us — the active goodness that pursues blessing for others. Grow GOODNESS in us — the moral courage to do right when no one is watching. Grow FAITHFULNESS in us — the reliability that reflects Your covenant-keeping nature. Grow GENTLENESS in us — the strength under control that handles people with care. Grow SELF-CONTROL in us — the Spirit-powered mastery over our impulses and desires.

We cannot produce these on our own. We need Your life flowing through us like a vine through its branches. Help us to abide — to stay connected to Christ through prayer, through Your Word, through worship, through community. Remove everything that disconnects us. Prune what needs pruning, even when it hurts. We trust Your process.

We surrender our timeline. We trust that You who began a good work in us will carry it on to completion. Make us patient with our own growth, knowing that fruit takes seasons to ripen. And may the fruit You produce in us bring glory to the Father, blessing to others, and joy to our own souls. In Jesus' name we pray. Amen.

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

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